



The Garamut **“The message sender”**

Ps Barry Reflections from **‘The WORD’!**

For PRAYER,
PROCLAMATION & PERSONAL
PROGRESS

Bethel Global Missions

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OUR THEME:

“OUR SCARS ARE OUR WITNESS”

I recently heard this phrase "our scars are our testimony" and my attention was immediately drawn to the scars and wounds of our precious Lord Jesus in his sufferings that he went through to redeem us from our sins.

So, in this reflection I would like to relate this statement “our scars” are our witness - to the truth that our past hurts and wounds may have left their “marks” on our life, but they show something positive about our faith and victory in God.

Our wounds and scars show our survival and strength. They show that we have battled the storms of life and conflict and have triumphed over them.

So, my focus today is on the wounds and hurts that believers have experienced as a result of facing life's storms, testings and temptations along with their conflicts with the devil and evil.

However, we do recognise that some of God's servants bear in their physical body wounds and scars as a result of accidents or conflicts while serving God in difficult or dangerous places.

BODILY SCARS

From my experience as a Missionary in Papua New Guinea, where there are many tribal fighting's take place, and as a result of those conflicts and wars, I have often seen men with huge raised up scar tissue on their bodies, which they have obviously been severely wounded, and after certain traditional or medical procedures, they have been healed of those wounds.

But their scars testify that they have engaged in conflict and came out a victor.

OUR SCARS ARE OUR TESTIMONY THAT SHOW OUR SURVIVAL AND STRENGTH.

OUR WOUNDS TESTIFY TO OUR SURVIVAL.

EVERY HURT AND WOUND WE CARRY TELLS A STORY OF OUR JOURNEY WITH GOD AND OUR EVENTUAL VICTORY AND TRIUMPH OVER ALL THE TRIALS AND STORMS OF LIFE.

OUR SCARS ARE THE QUIET PROOF THAT WE HAVE EXPERIENCED CONFLICT WITH THAT WHICH IS EVIL AND WITH THOSE OPPOSED TO GOD, BUT THEY GIVE WITNESS TO THE POWER OF THE VICTORY THAT IS OURS THROUGH JESUS CHRIST- THAT WE ARE TRULY MORE THAN CONQUERORS.

Romans 8:37 but despite all this, overwhelming victory is ours through Christ who loved us enough to die for us. TLB

THIS WAS TRUE FOR JESUS??

THE SCARS IN JESUS'S BODY – HIS HANDS, FEET AND SIDE ALL BEAR WITNESS TO HIS SUFFERING AND TESTIFY OF HIS MIGHTY TRIUMPH, FOR HE IS ALIVE- Hallelujah!

Luke 24:39-40

39 Look at My hands and My feet, that it is I Myself! Touch Me and see, because a ghost does not have flesh and bones as you can see I have."

40 Having said this, He showed them His hands and feet. Holman

John 20:27

27 Then he said to Thomas, "Put your finger here, and look at my hands. Put your hand into the wound in my side. Don't be faithless any longer. Believe!" NLT

Luke 24:39-40

39 Behold my hands and my feet, that it is I myself: handle me, and see; for a spirit hath not flesh and bones, as ye see me have.

40 And when he had thus spoken, he shewed them his hands and his feet. KJV

HOWEVER, THERE ARE MANY OTHER KINDS OF WOUNDS OR SCARS THAT PEOPLE EXPERIENCE WHICH HAVE VARYING EFFECTS ON THEIR LIVES.

THERE ARE **EMOTIONAL SCARS** THAT SOME PEOPLE EXPERIENCE THAT LEAVE THEIR MARK IN A NEGATIVE SENSE IN THEIR LIVES.

AND EMOTIONAL SCARS OR WOUNDS UNLIKE PHYSICAL SCARS, MANIFEST THEMSELVES IN BEHAVIOURAL PATTERNS, BELIEF SYSTEMS, AND HOW A PERSON RELATES TO THEIR WORLD.

EMOTIONAL SCARS CAN RESULT IN ALL KINDS OF FEAR, MISTRUST, SELF-DOUBT, CYNICISM, SUSPICION, EMBARRASSMENT AND LINGERING SHAME FROM BULLYING, OR ABUSE CYNICISM BORN OUT OF EXPERIENCING UNFAIR TREATMENT AND DISCRIMINATION.

BELIEVERS ALSO ARE SUBJECT TO ALL KINDS OF CHANGING AND CHALLENGING CIRCUMSTANCES AND EVENTS IN LIFE, AND SOME ARE WOUNDED IN THE PROCESS.

BUT THOSE WOUNDS TESTIFY THAT WE HAVE COME THROUGH VICTORIOUS.

BUT FOR THE BELIEVER, THOUGH SCARS REMIND US WHERE WE'VE BEEN, THEY DO NOT DICTATE OR DETERMINE WHERE WE'RE GOING.

LET US SEE THE WOUNDS AND SCARS THAT WE HAVE EXPERIENCED AS A RESULT OF BEING ENGAGED IN SERVICE FOR CHRIST, AS SOMETHING THAT IS POSITIVE – LIKE THE EXAMPLE OF THE APOSTLE PAUL.

Galatians 6: 14,16-17

17 From now on please don't argue with me about these things, for I carry on my body the scars of the whippings and wounds from Jesus' enemies that mark me as his slave.

14 As for me, God forbid that I should boast about anything except the cross of our Lord Jesus Christ. Because of that cross, my interest in all the attractive things of the world was killed long ago, and the world's interest in me is also long dead.

16 May God's mercy and peace be upon all of you who live by this principle and upon those everywhere who are really God's own. TLB

SOME NOTABLE TRUTHS FOR US TO REMEMBER.

- ✳ SCARS SHOW THAT WE OUTLIVED THE STORM.
- ✳ SCARS SERVE AS TANGIBLE EVIDENCE OF SURVIVAL, HEALING, AND RESILIENCE RATHER THAN SYMBOLS OF SHAME OR DEFEAT.
- ✳ THEY MIGHT BREAK US BUT THEY BUILD OUR LEGACY.
- ✳ SCARS ARE NOT PROOF THAT GOD ABANDONED US BUT LIVING EVIDENCE THAT WE SURVIVED AND BECAUSE HIS HEALING MIRACLE SHIFTS THE FOCUS FROM THE PAIN TO A PERFECT CLOSURE.
- ✳ SCARS MARK THE TRANSITION FROM VICTIM TO SURVIVOR.
- ✳ OUR SCARS SHOW OUR PAST HURTS BUT THEY ALSO TESTIFY OF OUR SURVIVAL AND STRENGTH.
- ✳ IT'S ABOUT TURNING WOUNDS INTO WORSHIP AND WISDOM.
- ✳ SCARS AND WOUNDS OFTEN TRAIN US IN EMPATHY AND COMPASSION FOR OTHERS WHO ARE ALSO EXPERIENCING PAIN.
- ✳ OUR SCARS ARE **THE POSITIVES OF OUR LIVES!**

AMEN Ps Barry